Lesson plan · for the teacher

Risk assessment: what could go wrong?

Cyber security · Level 4 · Lesson 2

Time
40 min

Materials
A 3 × 3 grid drawn on the board (likelihood across, impact up); Paper slips or small cards for writing risks; A sheet for the risk register: risk, score, control, owner, date

Learning goals

- List the school's information assets.
- Score risks by likelihood and impact on a 3 × 3 grid.
- Choose a control, an owner and a date for the top risks, in a simple register.

Activity: Risk hunt: our top three risks

1. Warm-up (5 min): Tell the story of the office computer that wouldn't start after a power cut, two weeks before exams, with the only copy of the papers on it. Ask: what would have saved us?
2. Assets (7 min): Together, list on the board what the school must protect: pupil records and marks, exam papers, fee records, staff email, the school's page and groups, the office computer and phones.
3. Score (13 min): In groups of three, write one risk per slip, score likelihood and impact from 1 to 3, and stick each slip on the 3 × 3 grid. Discuss any slip where groups disagree by more than one point.
4. Controls (10 min): Take the three highest scores. For each, agree one control (prevent, detect or recover), one owner by name, and a date within the month. Prefer free controls.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Copy the top three into the risk register sheet. Agree who keeps it and the date of the next review, and note which control can be done this week.

Draw a 3 × 3 grid on the board before the meeting: likelihood from 1 to 3 across, impact from 1 to 3 up, with the corner where 3 meets 3 marked "act now". Prepare paper slips and tape, and invite the bursar and whoever looks after the computers.

Discussion

- Which of our risks is likely but dull, and still not fixed?
- Which control could we put in place this week for free?
- Who should keep the register, and when do we look at it again?

Exit ticket

- Our highest risk, its score, and one control with an owner.

Try it at school tomorrow
With two colleagues, list five things that could go wrong with your school's data or devices. Score each one for likelihood and impact from 1 to 3, multiply, circle the top two, and give each an owner and a date.

Practice questions · for you

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1 **Someone checks the school page every morning. What kind of control is that?**

- ◯ Recover: it brings the page back
- ◯ Detect: it catches a takeover fast
- ◯ Prevent: it stops a takeover

2 **Complete the sentence.**

A risk's score is its likelihood multiplied by its _____. We fix the _____ scores first, and every control gets an _____ and a date.

Word bank: owner · cost · lowest · impact · highest

3 **Match each action to what it does about a risk.**

Two-step sign-in on staff email	• • • •	Recover
Sign-in alerts sent to the cyber lead	• • • •	Prevent
A weekly backup kept away from school	• • • •	Accept and watch
The printer jams now and then: note it and move on	• • • •	Detect

4 **A cyber risk assessment should include power cuts and floods, not only hackers.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

5 **Put the steps of a risk assessment in order.**

- ☐ List what could go wrong
- ☐ Review the register every term
- ☐ List what you are protecting
- ☐ Score each risk: likelihood × impact
- ☐ Choose a control, an owner and a date for the top risks

✎ **Which risk at your school do you think scores highest? What free control could lower it this month, and who should own it?**

Check your answers

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1 **Detect: it catches a takeover fast**

Looking at the page can't stop anyone getting in, and it doesn't restore anything by itself.

2 **A risk's score is its likelihood multiplied by its impact. We fix the highest scores first, and every control gets an owner and a date.**

Likelihood times impact puts the frequent and the serious at the top, and a fix with no named owner and no date rarely happens.

3 **Two-step sign-in on staff email — Prevent**
Sign-in alerts sent to the cyber lead — Detect
A weekly backup kept away from school — Recover
The printer jams now and then: note it and move on — Accept and watch

A good register mixes all three kinds of control for the top risks, and openly accepts the small ones, so time and money go where they matter.

4 **True**

Security means data is safe and available when you need it.

5 **Top to bottom: 2, 5, 1, 3, 4**

You can't judge a threat until you know what it threatens, and you can't choose what to fix until you have scored it.